

ESSENTIAL

Financial Requirements Overview

The Sperrkonto mechanism, alternatives, and health insurance

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

The Sperrkonto: a genuinely different financial mechanism

Unlike a lump sum you simply hold in an ordinary account, most applicants open a Sperrkonto (blocked account) with a German-approved provider and deposit a specific, published annual amount. Crucially, the funds aren't freely accessible once deposited - the account releases a capped monthly instalment (commonly framed as 1/12 of the annual amount) once you're in Germany, rather than letting you withdraw the full sum at once. This locked-disbursement structure is specific to Germany and genuinely different from a UK-style 28-day holding period or a Canada/Australia-style single lump-sum evidence requirement.

The published amount

The required annual Sperrkonto amount is published and updated periodically by German authorities - confirm the current figure directly before opening an account or relying on any number from an older source, including this guide's own calculator, which is a planning tool with an editable rate, not a live feed of the official figure.

Alternatives to a Sperrkonto

- A formal Verpflichtungserklärung from a financial sponsor resident in Germany, committing to cover your costs
- A scholarship confirmation letter from a recognised sponsoring body (e.g. DAAD or a similar organisation), for the amount and duration it covers
- A bank guarantee letter from specific approved banks, in some circumstances

Health insurance costs

Separately from the Sperrkonto, budget for your health insurance premium - GKV (statutory) premiums are set at a published rate for students; private insurance premiums vary by provider and your personal circumstances.

Red flags

- Using an account or provider not on the accepted Sperrkonto list
- A Sperrkonto amount that doesn't match the current published annual figure
- A sponsor letter or scholarship confirmation that doesn't clearly state the amount and duration of the commitment